

Dhāraṇī Following the Bodhimaṇḍa, Showing the Tathāgata's Wisdom

Toh 720 · Derge Kangyur

དཀར་མཆོག་གསུང་ལ་ཕྱག་འཇམ་ལོ་

Toh 720 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text concerned with the cultivation of wisdom and the power of retention, commonly known in English as the Dhāraṇī for Retaining What One Has Heard. It belongs to the dhāraṇī class of canonical literature, presenting a sacred mantra formula attributed to the Buddha Śākyamuni together with brief ritual instructions on how its recitation — including a practice involving medicine held in the palm — sharpens the intellect and enables the practitioner to remember whatever has been heard. The text was translated into Tibetan from Sanskrit by the Indian master Vidyākaraśiṃha in collaboration with the great translator-monk Devacandra, who requested and finalized the rendering, though a Sanskrit title is not explicitly preserved in the available source lines.

Translated by the Indian master Vidyākaraśiṃha and the great translator-monk Devacandra, who requested and finalized it.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha Śākyamuni.

The dhāraṇī is as follows:

tadyathā — mati bahulye tathāgatajñānadarśane prajñāptā gambhīre bodhimaṇḍānusāriṇī aviddha tamondha karavidhamani jvala jvala prajñāvīpe medhāpadini sarva adhiṣṭhita suru suru dhuru dhuru medhā ānaya svāhā.

If one performs the ritual inwardly and recites this mantra, one's intelligence will grow sharp. If one places medicine in the palm of the hand, recites the mantra until smoke arises, and then eats it, one will retain what one has heard.

This completes the dhāraṇī for retaining what one has heard.

Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables are transliterated from a corrupt or archaic Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit and cannot be reconstructed with certainty in every detail. The rendering given here follows the syllables as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic script, normalized toward recognizable Sanskrit. The phrase rendered "one's intelligence will grow sharp" translates a

Tibetan expression meaning literally "one will come to have sharp capacity or faculty," referring to intellectual acuity and receptivity to learning.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.